

The Goophered Grapevine

Charles W. Chesnutt · 1887

First published: The Atlantic Monthly, Aug 1887

TEACHER EDITION · CURRICULUM UNIT

Common Core edition (standards shown for this framework only)

One 90-minute lesson (the whole story), with an optional take-home essay

Syllabus · 90-minute lesson plans · lecture scripts · vocabulary · quizzes with keys · writing prompts at eleven rigor levels · SAT-style items · whole-book test · essays

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Contents and unit overview

1. Unit overview and the 90-minute lesson
2. Syllabus (weekly pacing)
3. Lesson 1: introduction (author, context, reception, overview)
4. Lesson plans and lecture scripts (chapters 1–1), each with vocabulary, discussion questions, annotation focus, quiz and key, writing prompts and SAT-style items
5. Unit test (eleven rigor versions) with answer keys and scoring guides
6. Final paper
7. Essay assignments at eleven rigor levels

Edition: Reading text: https://en.wikisource.org/wiki/The_Conjure_Woman/The_Goophered_Grapevine (revision 14117353), cleaned for Liber et Libri.

Grades: Grades 10–12 (scales to graduate via rigor levels). Short story: read whole in one 90-minute lesson (assign longer stories as pre-reading). The scaffolded-support track works from the full text with scaffolds. **Weeks:** 1. **Class days:** 2 × 90 minutes (1 chapter lessons plus seminar, test and essay days).

Essential questions

- What does The Goophered Grapevine suggest about slavery and its memory?
- What does The Goophered Grapevine suggest about storytelling as resistance?
- What does The Goophered Grapevine suggest about race and economics?

Objectives

- Students will cite at least 2 quotations, with locations, to support each written claim about what the text says explicitly and implicitly (scored on the writing-prompt rubric).
- Students will trace one theme across at least 3 sections of the story in the final paper, earning at least 70 of 100 rubric points.
- Students will explain how characters, setting and point of view interact in at least 3 exit tickets, each meeting the claim-evidence-reasoning criteria.
- Students will determine the in-context meaning of taught vocabulary, scoring at least 80% on the vocabulary items of the story quizzes.
- Students will write an argument with a clear claim, reasons and relevant evidence, scoring at least 80% on the unit test's short-answer scoring guides.

Standards: Common Core

RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2, RL.9-10.3, RL.9-10.4, RL.9-10.5, RL.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2, RL.11-12.4, RL.11-12.5, W.9-10.1, W.11-12.1, L.9-10.4, L.11-12.4

Common Core State Standards (ELA-Literacy), thecorestandards.org

Assessments: Daily story quizzes (auto-graded); Weekly writing prompt (rubric); Socratic seminars (scheduled days); Whole-story test (scheduled day); Final essay (scheduled day); College Sophomore and above write one essay of the five
Differentiation: Every prompt and quiz has eleven rigor levels (Scaffolded support through Graduate / PhD); the app applies student override, then class standard, then the automatic level. Each prompt is tagged for Common Core, Indiana 2023, Dual Credit (Indiana College Core), AP and Cambridge where they apply.
Materials: Liber et Libri reader; Annotation journal; Story lecture slides or script

The 90-minute lesson

#	Segment	Mode	Minutes	Clock
1	Bell-ringer	You do	8	0–8
2	Vocabulary with etymology notes	I do	10	8–18
3	Background and context	I do	10	18–28
4	I do: modeled close reading	I do	12	28–40
5	We do: guided annotation	We do	15	40–55
6	You do: independent annotation	You do	15	55–70
7	Discussion	We do	10	70–80
8	Exit ticket / chapter quiz	You do	7	80–87
9	Closure	I do	3	87–90
	Total		**90**	

Syllabus

Week	Chapters	Lessons	Focus and activities	Assessment
1	*Introduction: author, context and reception* The Goophered Grapevine	2 × 90 min (180 min)	*slavery and its memory* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Story quizzes in the app • Introduction: author, context and reception • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt

Lesson plans and lecture scripts

Each chapter is one 90-minute class. Scripts are a starting point; adapt them to your students. Teacher summaries contain spoilers.

Lesson 1: Introduction to The Goophered Grapevine

Objective: Students will explain, in a 3-sentence exit ticket, how one fact about Charles W. Chesnutt's life or times connects to slavery and its memory in “The Goophered Grapevine”, and will set up a reading journal with a prediction and a question for each of 3 themes (slavery and its memory, storytelling as resistance, race and economics).

Standards: CCSS RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2 · IN 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.RC.2

Author biography

Charles W. Chesnutt was born in Cleveland, Ohio, on 20 June 1858 to free Black parents from North Carolina and grew up in Fayetteville, where he became a teacher and school principal. He returned to Cleveland, passed the Ohio bar and ran a successful court-reporting business while writing. His conjure stories, the first of which was "The Goophered Grapevine" in The Atlantic Monthly (1887), were collected in The Conjure Woman (1899); his story The Marrow of Tradition (1901) depicts the 1898 Wilmington massacre. He received the NAACP's Spingarn Medal in 1928 and died on 15 November 1932.

Historical and cultural context

Set in North Carolina after Reconstruction, when Northern investors were buying up Southern land. The storyteller, Uncle Julius, is a formerly enslaved man who recounts plantation days in dialect. White writers of the period such as Joel Chandler Harris used similar storytellers to romanticize slavery; Chesnutt reworks the form to expose its cruelty and to show Julius's own shrewdness.

Publication and reception, then and now

First published in The Atlantic Monthly in August 1887, making Chesnutt one of the first African American writers published there; collected in The Conjure Woman (1899).

Then: Most readers did not know Chesnutt was Black; his race was publicized only later.

Now: Recognized as a landmark of African American literature and a subtle critique of the plantation tradition.

Overview (spoiler-free)

A Northern businessman, John, considers buying a run-down vineyard in North Carolina. Uncle Julius warns him that the vines are "goophered" (bewitched) and tells the story of Henry, an enslaved man whose life became tied to the vines.

Main themes

- the economics of slavery.
- storytelling as resistance.
- exploitation.

Why it matters

Students learn to read layered narration and to see how dialect and frame stories can carry hidden critique.

Spoilers · teacher only

John buys the vineyard anyway, and reveals that Julius had been profiting from the grapes himself; the tale was partly a strategy to protect his livelihood.

Lesson plan (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Before we open The Goophered Grapevine: Have you ever told a story to persuade someone without saying what you really wanted?
Prompt: Before we open The Goophered Grapevine: Have you ever told a story to persuade someone without saying what you really wanted?

8–18 min · Key terms · I do (10 min)
Key literary terms for the unit.
frame narrative; dialect; conjure; trickster; plantation tradition.

18–28 min · Mini-lecture: author, context, reception · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture on the author, the historical context and the reception (read or adapt the script).
About the author. Charles W. Chesnutt was born in Cleveland, Ohio, on 20 June 1858 to free Black parents from North Carolina and grew up in Fayetteville, where he became a teacher and school principal. He returned to Cleveland, passed the Ohio bar and ran a successful court-reporting business while writing. His conjure stories, the first of which was "The Goophered Grapevine" in The Atlantic Monthly (1887), were collected in The Conjure Woman (1899); his story The Marrow of Tradition (1901) depicts the 1898 Wilmington massacre. He received the NAACP's Spingarn Medal in 1928 and died on 15 November 1932. The world of the book. Set in North Carolina after Reconstruction, when Northern investors were buying up Southern land. The storyteller, Uncle Julius, is a formerly enslaved man who recounts plantation days in dialect. White writers of the period such as Joel Chandler Harris used similar storytellers to romanticize slavery; Chesnutt reworks the form to expose its cruelty and to show Julius's own shrewdness. Publication and reception. First published in The Atlantic Monthly in August 1887, making Chesnutt one of the first African American writers published there; collected in The Conjure Woman (1899). Then: Most readers did not know Chesnutt was Black; his race was publicized only later. Now: Recognized as a landmark of African American literature and a subtle critique of the plantation tradition.

28–40 min · I do: the book in one passage · I do (12 min)
Model a close reading of one passage using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Some years ago my wife was in poor health, and our family doctor, in whose skill and honesty I had implicit confidence, advised a change..." slowly and put it in my own words: the book opens by placing us inside its world before we know what is at stake. Next, craft. I notice that the sentence piles up clause after clause, so the pressure builds as I read. The word "confidence" is the strongest in the line; it sharpens the picture more than a plainer word would. Then, effect. What does this suggest about life beyond the story? My answer: A Northern businessman, John, considers buying a run-down vineyard in North Carolina.

> *Some years ago my wife was in poor health, and our family doctor, in whose skill and honesty I had implicit confidence, advised a change of climate.* *(The Goophered Grapevine, paragraph 1)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Some years ago my wife was in poor health, and our family doctor, in whose skill and honesty I had implicit confidence, advised a change…" slowly and put it in my own words: the book opens by placing us inside its world before we know what is at stake. Next, craft. I notice that the sentence piles up clause after clause, so the pressure builds as I read. The word "confidence" is the strongest in the line; it sharpens the picture more than a plainer word would. Then, effect. What does this suggest about life beyond the story? My answer: A Northern businessman, John, considers buying a run-down vineyard in North Carolina.

40–55 min · We do: overview and themes · We do (15 min)
Read the spoiler-free overview together and name the themes to track.
What the book is about (no spoilers): A Northern businessman, John, considers buying a run-down vineyard in North Carolina. Uncle Julius warns him that the vines are "goophered" (bewitched) and tells the story of Henry, an enslaved man whose life became tied to the vines. Themes to track: the economics of slavery.: storytelling as resistance.: exploitation.:

55–70 min · You do: reading journal · You do (15 min)
Set up a reading journal: one page per theme, with a prediction and a question (example given).
Set up a reading journal: one page per theme with a prediction and a question. Example page. Theme: the economics of slavery. Prediction: I expect this idea to be tested when a character has to choose between what they want and what others expect. Question: what will The Goophered Grapevine suggest about the economics of slavery by the end?
Task: Set up a reading journal for The Goophered Grapevine: one page per theme, each with a prediction and a question.
Exemplar: Example page. Theme: the economics of slavery. Prediction: I expect this idea to be tested when a character has to choose between what they want and what others expect. Question: what will The Goophered Grapevine suggest about the economics of slavery by the end?

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Whole-class discussion: why the book is still taught.
Why does The Goophered Grapevine still matter? Students learn to read layered narration and to see how dialect and frame stories can carry hidden critique.
Anchor question: Why might The Goophered Grapevine still be taught today?
Facilitation: Students learn to read layered narration and to see how dialect and frame stories can carry hidden critique.

80–87 min · Exit ticket · You do (7 min)
Exit ticket on the author and context (answer given).
Why does Julius tell the story? Answer: Partly to keep John from buying the vineyard, which Julius was using; partly to reveal the cruelty of slavery.
Exit ticket: Why does Julius tell the story?
Answer: Partly to keep John from buying the vineyard, which Julius was using; partly to reveal the cruelty of slavery.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Preview the first reading.
Tomorrow we begin reading: The Goophered Grapevine.

Teacher notes · sources: The Charles Chesnutt Digital Archive (https://chesnuttarchive.org/); Britannica, "Charles W. Chesnutt" (https://www.britannica.com/biography/Charles-W-Chesnutt); The Charles Chesnutt Digital Archive (https://www.chesnuttarchive.org/)

Flags (verify before teaching):

- Content note: the dialect passages include a racial slur used by and about enslaved characters. Teaching note: the dialect reflects nineteenth-century conventions; prepare students for it and discuss why Chesnutt used it.

Lesson 2: The Goophered Grapevine

Focus: a story told to protect a livelihood

Objective: Students will analyze how point of view develops in "The Goophered Grapevine" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: CCSS RL.9-10.1, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4 · IN 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.9, 9-10.RC.11

Content note (slavery, heavy dialect, a racial slur used by the characters, alcohol or drugs (mentioned)): Sensitive content: Slavery; heavy dialect; a racial slur used by the characters. Preview the story, tell students in advance, and allow a pass on reading aloud. Keep discussion on how the writer uses these elements, not on graphic detail. The text quotes racial slurs in period dialogue: decide in advance that no one reads them aloud, and name why the author records them. This section mentions drinking or a drug ("…Mars Dugal' made a thousan' gallon er scuppernon' wine eve'y year. "Now, ef dey's an'thing a n…"). Treat it as period custom or plot detail; name it plainly and don't glamorize it.
Student preview: Heads-up: this story includes slavery; heavy dialect; a racial slur used by the characters.
Suggested language: "Why does the writer include this, and what does it make us notice?"

Teacher only · spoilers

A white Northerner, John, considers buying a run-down North Carolina vineyard. Julius McAdoo, a formerly enslaved man, tells him it is 'goophered' (conjured): before the war, an enslaved man named Henry ate its grapes, and his life rose and fell with the vines until he died. John buys anyway and later suspects Julius told the tale because he profited from the grapes; he hires Julius as coachman.

Background: Published in The Atlantic Monthly in 1887, the first story by an African American writer in that magazine; collected in The Conjure Woman (1899).

Significance: Chesnutt reworks the 'plantation tradition' frame to expose slavery's cruelty and Black economic agency.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Why might someone tell a story that is not literally true? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to the economics of slavery because.... Content note before we start: Heads-up: this story includes slavery; heavy dialect; a racial slur used by the characters.
Prompt: Why might someone tell a story that is not literally true?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to the economics of slavery because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Henry is treated as property whose value rises and falls with the vines.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: desuetude — a state of disuse; no longer being used or kept up; trellises — frames of crossed strips on which climbing plants grow; shiftless — lazy and lacking ambition; monologue — a long speech by one person; shyness — a feeling of fear of embarrassment. "trellises": Origin of "trellis": Anglo-Norman treslis; earlier Latin trichila ("arbor").
Words: desuetude: a state of disuse; no longer being used or kept up · trellises: frames of crossed strips on which climbing plants grow · shiftless: lazy and lacking ambition · monologue: a long speech by one person · shyness: a feeling of fear of embarrassment

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Published in The Atlantic Monthly in 1887, the first story by an African American writer in that magazine; collected in The Conjure Woman (1899). Chesnutt reworks the 'plantation tradition' frame to expose slavery's cruelty and Black economic agency. FrameNarrative: John narrates in standard English; Julius's tale is told in dialect, letting two worldviews collide. Irony: The "superstitious" story is economically shrewd. Characterization: Julius is a trickster figure, wiser than John realizes. Watch for the grapevine: Henry's life and the plantation economy.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "goophered" slowly and put it in my own words: The bewitchment. Next, craft. I notice that the line is short and blunt, so it lands hard and leaves no room to argue. Then, effect. How does this work as framenarrative? My answer: John narrates in standard English; Julius's tale is told in dialect, letting two worldviews collide.

> *goophered* *(The Goophered Grapevine, paragraph 17)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "goophered" slowly and put it in my own words: The bewitchment. Next, craft. I notice that the line is short and blunt, so it lands hard and leaves no room to argue. Then, effect. How does this work as framenarrative? My answer: John narrates in standard English; Julius's tale is told in dialect, letting two worldviews collide.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Henry sold as property, his price tied to the vines. Look at the craft: The "superstitious" story is economically shrewd. Ask: How does this line connect to the economics of slavery? Expected: Henry is treated as property whose value rises and falls with the vines. (Henry sold as property, his price tied to the vines.)

> *Mars Dugal' up 'n tuk Henry ter town, en sole 'im fer fifteen hunder' dollars (The Goophered Grapevine, paragraph 40)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Henry sold as property, his price tied to the vines. Look at the craft: The "superstitious" story is economically shrewd.
Ask: How does this line connect to the economics of slavery?
Expected answer: Henry is treated as property whose value rises and falls with the vines. (Henry sold as property, his price tied to the vines.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the story for framenarrative, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this story suggest about a story told to protect a livelihood? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how The Goophered Grapevine develops the idea of a story told to protect a livelihood. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and diction / vocabulary shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Julius's tale is both entertainment and an act of resistance. When the text says "Mars Dugal' up 'n tuk Henry ter town, en sole 'im fer fifteen hunder' dollars" (The Goophered Grapevine, paragraph 40), it shows this directly. The "goophered" vines protect his own income, and the detail that the master "sole 'im fer fifteen hunder' dollars" when Henry was strong exposes an economy that treated a man like a crop.
Task: Annotate the story for framenarrative, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this story suggest about a story told to protect a livelihood? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how The Goophered Grapevine develops the idea of a story told to protect a livelihood. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and diction / vocabulary shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Julius's tale is both entertainment and an act of resistance. When the text says "Mars Dugal' up 'n tuk Henry ter town, en sole 'im fer fifteen hunder' dollars" (The Goophered Grapevine, paragraph 40), it shows this directly. The "goophered" vines protect his own income, and the detail that the master "sole 'im fer fifteen hunder' dollars" when Henry was strong exposes an economy that treated a man like a crop.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Why might someone tell a story that is not literally true? Ask: who is the smartest character?
Anchor question: Why might someone tell a story that is not literally true?
Facilitation: Ask: who is the smartest character?

> **80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
> Story quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
> *Story quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this story suggest about a story told to protect a livelihood? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Julius's tale is both entertainment and an act of resistance. (“Mars Dugal' up 'n tuk Henry ter town, en sole 'im fer fifteen hunder' dollars”, The Goophered Grapevine, paragraph 40). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the story; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*
> **Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this story suggest about a story told to protect a livelihood? Support it with one short quotation.
> **Answer:** Model answer: Julius's tale is both entertainment and an act of resistance. (“Mars Dugal' up 'n tuk Henry ter town, en sole 'im fer fifteen hunder' dollars”, The Goophered Grapevine, paragraph 40). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the story; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how framenarrative shapes a story told to protect a livelihood. Key takeaway: Henry is treated as property whose value rises and falls with the vines.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **FrameNarrative:** John narrates in standard English; Julius's tale is told in dialect, letting two worldviews collide.
- **Irony:** The "superstitious" story is economically shrewd.
- **Characterization:** Julius is a trickster figure, wiser than John realizes.

Themes and how they develop

- **the economics of slavery:** Henry is treated as property whose value rises and falls with the vines.

Symbols and motifs

- **the grapevine:** Henry's life and the plantation economy.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “goophered” (The Goophered Grapevine, paragraph 17) The bewitchment.
- “Mars Dugal' up 'n tuk Henry ter town, en sole 'im fer fifteen hunder' dollars” (The Goophered Grapevine, paragraph 40) Henry sold as property, his price tied to the vines.
- “he paid Aun' Peggy ten dollars fer to goopher de grapevimes” (The Goophered Grapevine, paragraph 31) Conjure as a business arrangement.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Julius's tale is both entertainment and an act of resistance.
Evidence: “Mars Dugal' up 'n tuk Henry ter town, en sole 'im fer fifteen hunder' dollars” (The Goophered Grapevine, paragraph 40)
Reasoning: The "goophered" vines protect his own income, and the detail that the master "sole 'im fer fifteen hunder' dollars" when Henry was strong exposes an economy that treated a man like a crop.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
desuetude (noun)	a state of disuse; no longer being used or kept up	*Several planters thereabouts had attempted it on a commercial scale, in former years, with greater or less success; but like most Southern industries, it had felt the blight of war and had fallen into desuetude.*	
trellises (noun)	frames of crossed strips on which climbing plants grow	*The vines—here partly supported by decayed and broken-down trellises, there twining themselves among the branches of the slender saplings which had sprung up among them—grew in wild and unpruned luxuriance, and the few scattered grapes they bore were the undisputed prey of the first comer.*	“trellises”: Origin of “trellis”: Anglo-Norman treslis; earlier Latin trichila (“arbor”). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/trellis#Etymology)
shiftless (adjective)	lazy and lacking ambition	*The estate had been for years involved in litigation between disputing heirs, during which period shiftless cultivation had well-nigh exhausted the soil.*	
monologue (noun)	a long speech by one person	*As he became more and more absorbed in the narrative, his eyes assumed a dreamy expression, and he seemed to lose sight of his auditors, and to be living over again in monologue his life on the old plantation.*	
shyness (noun)	a feeling of fear of embarrassment	*After a little patient investigation, necessary to overcome the child's shyness, we learned what we wished to know, and at the end of about five miles from the town reached our destination.*	
imparted (verb)	gave; passed on	*He imparted this information with such solemn earnestness, and with such an air of confidential mystery, that I felt somewhat interested, while Annie was*	“imparted”: Origin of “impart”: Middle French impartir; earlier Late Latin impartiō. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://

		evidently much impressed, and drew closer to me.	en.wiktionary.org/wiki/impart#Etymology)
equivalent (noun)	a person or thing equal to another in value or measure or force or effect or significance etc	*I believe, however, that the wages I paid him for his services as coachman, for I gave him employment in that capacity, were more than an equivalent for anything he lost by the sale of the vineyard.*	“equivalent”: Origin: Latin aequivalentem. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/equivalent#Etymology)
litigation (noun)	the process of taking a dispute to court	*The estate had been for years involved in litigation between disputing heirs, during which period shiftless cultivation had well-nigh exhausted the soil.*	“litigation”: Origin: Latin līt̄igātiō. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/litigation#Etymology)
luscious (adjective)	richly sweet and delicious	*The luscious scuppernong holds first rank among our grapes, though we cultivate a great many other varieties, and our income from grapes packed and shipped to the Northern markets is quite considerable.*	
hospitably (adverb)	in a warm, welcoming way toward guests	*We found the weather delightful at that season, the end of summer, and were hospitably entertained.*	

Discussion questions

1. Why might someone tell a story that is not literally true?
2. Where does point of view appear in this story, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this story connect to the book's larger concern with slavery and its memory?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Why does John come to North Carolina? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: His wife needs a milder climate and he seeks a business
2. Who tells the tale of the vineyard? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Uncle Julius McAdoo
3. What is a 'goopher'? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A conjure spell

4. What happens to Henry with the seasons? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He grows young and strong with the vines, then weak
5. What does John suspect about Julius's story? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Julius profited from the grapes and wanted to keep them
6. Retell the three most important events of "The Goophered Grapevine" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A white Northerner, John, considers buying a run-down North Carolina vineyard. Julius McAdoo, a formerly enslaved man, tells him it is 'goophered' (conjured): before the war, an enslaved man named Henry ate its grapes, and his life rose and fell with the vines until he died. John buys anyway and later suspects Julius told the tale because he profited from the grapes; he hires Julius as coachman.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "The Goophered Grapevine"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the story; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does "The Goophered Grapevine" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the story.
9. Reread: "Several planters thereabouts had attempted it on a commercial scale, in former years, with greater or less success; but like most Southern industries, it had felt the blight of war and had fallen into desuetude." What does "desuetude" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: desuetude: a state of disuse; no longer being used or kept up.
10. Reread: "The vines—here partly supported by decayed and broken-down trellises, there twining themselves among the branches of the slender saplings which had sprung up among them—grew in wild and unpruned luxuriance, and the few…" What does "trellises" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: trellises: frames of crossed strips on which climbing plants grow.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does "The Goophered Grapevine" suggest about a story told to protect a livelihood? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Chesnutt reworks the 'plantation tradition' frame to expose slavery's cruelty and Black economic agency.
2. Find one example of point of view in this story. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know.
3. How does the diction / vocabulary in this story shape what we understand about a story told to protect a livelihood? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for precise or unusual word choices and their connotations.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Julius's tale is both entertainment and an act of resistance. Useful evidence: "goophered" (The Goophered Grapevine, paragraph 17): The bewitchment. Theme link: Henry is treated as property whose value rises and falls with the vines. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins "We found the weather delightful at that season, the end of summer, and were hospitably entertained.", why might Chesnutt have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain

their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

5. What causes the main turn in “The Goophered Grapevine”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: A white Northerner, John, considers buying a run-down North Carolina vineyard. Julius McAdoo, a formerly enslaved man, tells him it is 'goophered' (conjured): before the war, an enslaved man named Henry ate its grapes, and his life rose and fell with the vines until he died. John buys anyway and…
6. As the opening story, what does “The Goophered Grapevine” set up that the rest of The Goophered Grapevine will need? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous story.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Julius's tale is both entertainment and an act of resistance. Useful evidence: “Mars Dugal' up 'n tuk Henry ter town, en sole 'im fer fifteen hunder' dollars” (The Goophered Grapevine, paragraph 40): Henry sold as property, his price tied to the vines. Theme link: Henry is treated as property whose value rises and falls with the vines. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Julius's tale is both entertainment and an act of resistance. Useful evidence: “he paid Aun' Peggy ten dollars fer to goopher de grapevimes” (The Goophered Grapevine, paragraph 31): Conjure as a business arrangement. On characterization: Julius is a trickster figure, wiser than John realizes. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “Why might someone tell a story that is not literally true?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does irony appear, and how does it connect this story to the larger concern with slavery and its memory? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Julius's tale is both entertainment and an act of resistance. Useful evidence: “goophered” (The Goophered Grapevine, paragraph 17): The bewitchment. On irony: The "superstitious" story is economically shrewd. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: Published in The Atlantic Monthly in 1887, the first story by an African American writer in that magazine; collected in The Conjure Woman (1899). How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the story? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Julius's tale is both entertainment and an act of resistance. Useful evidence: “Mars Dugal' up 'n tuk Henry ter town, en sole 'im fer fifteen hunder' dollars” (The Goophered Grapevine, paragraph 40): Henry sold as property, his price tied to the vines. Theme link: Henry is treated as property whose value rises and falls with the vines. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “Chesnutt reworks the 'plantation tradition' frame to expose slavery's cruelty and Black economic agency.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the story. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Julius's tale is both entertainment and an act of resistance. Useful evidence: “he paid Aun' Peggy ten dollars fer to goopher de grapevimes” (The Goophered Grapevine, paragraph 31): Conjure as a business arrangement. Theme link: Henry is treated as property whose value rises and falls with the vines. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this story acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Julius's tale is both entertainment and an act of resistance. Useful evidence: “goophered” (The Goophered Grapevine, paragraph 17): The bewitchment. On characterization: Julius is a trickster figure, wiser than John realizes. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Rewrite one moment of “The Goophered Grapevine” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about a story told to protect a livelihood? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Julius's tale is both entertainment and an act of resistance. Useful evidence: “Mars Dugal' up 'n tuk Henry ter town, en sole 'im fer fifteen hunder' dollars” (The Goophered Grapevine, paragraph 40): Henry sold as property, his price tied to the vines. Theme link: Henry is treated as property whose value rises and falls with the vines. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Write three questions of your own about “The Goophered Grapevine”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Julius's tale is both entertainment and an act of resistance. Useful evidence: “he paid Aun' Peggy ten dollars fer to goopher de grapevimes” (The Goophered Grapevine, paragraph 31): Conjure as a business arrangement. Theme link: Henry is treated as property whose value rises and falls with the vines. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Connect this story to storytelling as resistance: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Chesnutt need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Julius's tale is both entertainment and an act of resistance. Useful evidence: “goophered” (The Goophered Grapevine, paragraph 17): The bewitchment. Theme link: Henry is treated as property whose value rises and falls with the vines. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Is the point of view in this story effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria

and evidence.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Julius's tale is both entertainment and an act of resistance. Useful evidence: “Mars Dugal' up 'n tuk Henry ter town, en sole 'im fer fifteen hunder' dollars” (The Goophered Grapevine, paragraph 40): Henry sold as property, his price tied to the vines. Theme link: Henry is treated as property whose value rises and falls with the vines. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “The Goophered Grapevine” treats a story told to protect a livelihood with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Goophered Grapevine see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Julius's tale is both entertainment and an act of resistance. Useful evidence: “he paid Aun' Peggy ten dollars fer to goopher de grapevimes” (The Goophered Grapevine, paragraph 31): Conjure as a business arrangement. Theme link: Henry is treated as property whose value rises and falls with the vines. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. As the final story, does this ending resolve slavery and its memory? Argue whether the ending is earned. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Julius's tale is both entertainment and an act of resistance. Useful evidence: “goophered” (The Goophered Grapevine, paragraph 17): The bewitchment. Theme link: Henry is treated as property whose value rises and falls with the vines. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this story (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about a story told to protect a livelihood? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Julius's tale is both entertainment and an act of resistance. Useful evidence: “Mars Dugal' up 'n tuk Henry ter town, en sole 'im fer fifteen hunder' dollars” (The Goophered Grapevine, paragraph 40): Henry sold as property, his price tied to the vines. Theme link: Henry is treated as property whose value rises and falls with the vines. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Charles W. Chesnutt about this story, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Julius's tale is both entertainment and an act of resistance. Useful evidence: “he paid Aun' Peggy ten dollars fer to goopher de grapevimes” (The Goophered Grapevine, paragraph 31): Conjure as a business arrangement. Theme link: Henry is treated as property whose value rises and falls with the vines. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Point of view:** look for who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Diction / vocabulary**: precise or unusual word choices and their connotations

- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What happens to Henry with the seasons?
   A. He is sold
   B. He escapes north
   C. He becomes free
   D. He grows young and strong with the vines, then weak

   Key: D (He grows young and strong with the vines, then weak)
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does John suspect about Julius's story?
   A. Julius wanted to buy the land
   B. Julius profited from the grapes and wanted to keep them
   C. It was all true
   D. Julius was afraid

   Key: B (Julius profited from the grapes and wanted to keep them)
3. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "The estate had been for years involved in _____ between disputing heirs, during which period shiftless cultivation had well-nigh exhausted the soil." Word bank: shiftless, desuetude, litigation, trellises

   Key: litigation
4. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "He _____ this information with such solemn earnestness, and with such an air of confidential mystery, that I felt somewhat interested, while Annie was evidently much impressed, and drew closer to me." Word bank: trellises, desuetude, shiftless, imparted

   Key: imparted
5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who tells the tale of the vineyard?
   A. Uncle Julius McAdoo
   B. Henry
   C. The narrator's wife
   D. Aunt Peggy

   Key: A (Uncle Julius McAdoo)
6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from The Goophered Grapevine, paragraph 31: "he paid Aun' Peggy ten dollars fer to goopher de _____"

   Key: grapevimes
7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Why does John come to North Carolina?
   A. His wife needs a milder climate and he seeks a business
   B. To fight in a war
   C. To visit family
   D. To teach

   Key: A (His wife needs a milder climate and he seeks a business)
8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What is a 'goopher'?
   A. A ghost

B. A conjure spell

C. A kind of grape

D. A plantation tool

Key: B (A conjure spell)

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “I believe, however, that the wages I paid him for his services as coachman, for I gave him employment in that capacity, were more than an _____ for anything he lost by the sale of the vineyard.” Word bank: shiftless, desuetude, trellises, equivalent

   Key: equivalent

10. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from The Goophered Grapevine, paragraph 40: “Mars Dugal' up 'n tuk Henry ter town, en sole 'im fer _____ hunder' dollars”

    Key: fifteen

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “The Goophered Grapevine”?

    A. The cost of wanting to seem richer than you are

    B. Friendship tested by duty

    C. A story told to protect a livelihood

    D. A boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion

    Key: C (A story told to protect a livelihood)

12. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “goophered” (The Goophered Grapevine, paragraph 17) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The bewitchment.

13. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Mars Dugal' up 'n tuk Henry ter town, en sole 'im fer fifteen hunder' dollars” (The Goophered Grapevine, paragraph 40) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Henry sold as property, his price tied to the vines.

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “The Goophered Grapevine”? John narrates in standard English; Julius's tale is told in dialect, letting two worldviews collide.

    A. FrameNarrative

    B. Setting

    C. Hyperbole

    D. Imagery

    Key: A (FrameNarrative)

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Julius's tale is both entertainment and an act of resistance. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Mars Dugal' up 'n tuk Henry ter town, en sole 'im fer fifteen hunder' dollars” (The Goophered Grapevine, paragraph 40).

    Sample answer: The "goophered" vines protect his own income, and the detail that the master "sole 'im fer fifteen hunder' dollars" when Henry was strong exposes an economy that treated a man like a crop.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the story: “Julius's tale is both entertainment and an act of resistance.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: The "goophered" vines protect his own income, and the detail that the master "sole 'im fer fifteen hunder' dollars" when Henry was strong exposes an economy that treated a man like a crop.

17. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “The Goophered Grapevine”? The "superstitious" story is economically shrewd.

    A. Diction / vocabulary

    B. Irony

    C. Characterization

    D. Alliteration

    Key: B (Irony)

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “After a little patient investigation, necessary to overcome the child's _____, we learned what we wished to know, and at the end of about five miles from the town reached our destination.” Word bank: trellises, shiftless, desuetude, shyness

    Key: shyness

19. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “he paid Aun' Peggy ten dollars fer to goopher de grapevimes” (The Goophered Grapevine, paragraph 31). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Conjure as a business arrangement.

20. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Mars Dugal' up 'n tuk Henry ter town, en sole 'im fer fifteen hunder' dollars” (The Goophered Grapevine, paragraph 40) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Henry sold as property, his price tied to the vines.

21. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “goophered” (The Goophered Grapevine, paragraph 17) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: The bewitchment.

22. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how the economics of slavery develops from an earlier story to “The Goophered Grapevine”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Henry is treated as property whose value rises and falls with the vines.

23. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Several planters thereabouts had attempted it on a commercial scale, in former years, with greater or less success; but like most Southern industries, it had felt the blight of war and had fallen into desuetude.”, what does “desuetude” most nearly mean?

    A. a state of disuse; no longer being used or kept up

    B. frames of crossed strips on which climbing plants grow

    C. lazy and lacking ambition

    D. a long speech by one person

    Key: A (a state of disuse; no longer being used or kept up)

24. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “The estate had been for years involved in litigation between disputing heirs, during which period shiftless cultivation had well-nigh exhausted the soil.”, what does “shiftless” most nearly mean?

    A. frames of crossed strips on which climbing plants grow

    B. a long speech by one person

    C. lazy and lacking ambition

    D. a state of disuse; no longer being used or kept up

    Key: C (lazy and lacking ambition)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 10, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	8, 5, 4, 2, 6, 1, 10, 7, 9, 13, 11, 12, 14, 17, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	5, 4, 6, 1, 8, 18, 3, 10, 12, 13, 11, 14, 15, 19, 20, 21	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	2, 10, 18, 7, 4, 6, 5, 13, 12, 11, 14, 19, 15, 17, 16, 22	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	5, 4, 6, 3, 10, 9, 11, 12, 13, 19, 15, 17, 14, 22, 20, 21	recall 6, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	4, 23, 24, 7, 18, 12, 13, 11, 14, 17, 19, 15, 16, 22, 21, 20	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Freshman	23, 9, 7, 5, 4, 11, 13, 12, 19, 17, 15, 14, 22, 20, 21, 16	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	2, 6, 10, 7, 24, 13, 12, 11, 15, 19, 14, 17, 20, 21, 16, 22	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Junior	18, 3, 1, 4, 9, 12, 11, 13, 14, 15, 19, 17, 16, 22, 20, 21	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Senior	10, 9, 8, 7, 18, 11, 12, 13, 15, 17, 19, 14, 21, 16, 22, 20	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
Graduate / PhD	9, 8, 3, 10, 6, 12, 13, 11, 17, 14, 15, 19, 21, 22, 20, 16	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “The Goophered Grapevine,” how does Chesnutt show a story told to protect a livelihood? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the point of view you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1, W.9-10.1): In The Goophered Grapevine, how does Chesnutt develop the idea of a story told to protect a livelihood? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the point of view in the story helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1, W.9-10.1): Analyze how The Goophered Grapevine develops the idea of a story told to protect a livelihood. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and diction / vocabulary shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of The Goophered Grapevine (where it begins, turns and ends) and its point of view shape the reader's understanding of a story told to protect a livelihood. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what The Goophered Grapevine suggests about a story told to protect a livelihood. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the story's point of view and diction / vocabulary), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Charles W. Chesnutt uses point of view in The Goophered Grapevine to complicate the reader's understanding of a story told to protect a livelihood. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate The Goophered Grapevine within its historical and literary context and argue how the story's treatment of a story told to protect a livelihood responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read The Goophered Grapevine alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the story's handling of a story told to protect a livelihood follows or bends those conventions, using the point of view as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to The Goophered Grapevine and its treatment of a story told to protect a livelihood. State your method, show what it reveals in the story's point of view and diction / vocabulary, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads The Goophered Grapevine as evidence for a larger claim about a story told to protect a livelihood in The Goophered Grapevine. Connect close reading of the story to the whole story, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads The Goophered Grapevine as a hinge in the story's larger treatment of a story told to protect a livelihood. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Goophered Grapevine.

SAT-style questions

1. *The estate had been for years involved in litigation between disputing heirs, during which period shiftless cultivation had well-nigh exhausted the soil.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “shiftless” most nearly mean?

   A. lazy and lacking ambition

   B. in a warm, welcoming way toward guests

   C. richly sweet and delicious

   D. the process of taking a dispute to court

2. *We found the weather delightful at that season, the end of summer, and were hospitably entertained. Our host was a man of means and evidently regarded our visit as a pleasure, and we were therefore correspondingly at our ease, and in a position to act with the coolness of judgment desirable in making so radical a change in our lives. My cousin placed a horse and buggy at our disposal, and himself acted as our guide until I became somewhat familiar with the country.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "The Goophered Grapevine"?

A. A story told to protect a livelihood

B. Superstition used against a credulous man

C. The cost of wanting to seem richer than you are

D. Revenge carried out with perfect control

SAT key: 1. A (lazy and lacking ambition); 2. A (A story told to protect a livelihood)

Unit test

The Goophered Grapevine: end test · 90 minutes · 18 questions per rigor version (multiple choice, fill in the blank, short answer). The class rigor level picks the version; student auto-adjust applies.

Short-answer scoring guides

Scaffolded support and HS Freshman (2 points): correct answer in a complete sentence with a detail from the text. HS Sophomore to HS Senior (3 points): claim, one accurate quotation, one sentence of explanation. AP to College Sophomore (4 points): precise claim, two embedded quotations, commentary on word choice or structure, link to theme. College Junior to Graduate (5 points): nuanced thesis, close reading of two passages, synthesis across sections, a competing reading answered. Each item lists a sample answer; partial credit is described in the app.

Unit test: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “I believe, however, that the wages I paid him for his services as coachman, for I gave him employment in that capacity, were more than an _____ for anything he lost by the sale of the vineyard.” Word bank: shiftless, desuetude, trellises, equivalent
   Key: equivalent
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who tells the tale of the vineyard?
   A. Uncle Julius McAdoo
   B. Henry
   C. The narrator's wife
   D. Aunt Peggy
   Key: A (Uncle Julius McAdoo)
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What is a 'goopher'?
   A. A ghost
   B. A conjure spell
   C. A kind of grape
   D. A plantation tool
   Key: B (A conjure spell)
4. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “The estate had been for years involved in _____ between disputing heirs, during which period shiftless cultivation had well-nigh exhausted the soil.” Word bank: shiftless, desuetude, litigation, trellises
   Key: litigation
5. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “He _____ this information with such solemn earnestness, and with such an air of confidential mystery, that I felt somewhat interested, while Annie was evidently much impressed, and drew closer to me.” Word bank: trellises, desuetude, shiftless, imparted
   Key: imparted
6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What happens to Henry with the seasons?
   A. He is sold
   B. He escapes north

C. He becomes free

D. He grows young and strong with the vines, then weak

Key: D (He grows young and strong with the vines, then weak)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does John suspect about Julius's story?

   A. Julius wanted to buy the land

   B. Julius profited from the grapes and wanted to keep them

   C. It was all true

   D. Julius was afraid

   Key: B (Julius profited from the grapes and wanted to keep them)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “After a little patient investigation, necessary to overcome the child's _____, we learned what we wished to know, and at the end of about five miles from the town reached our destination.” Word bank: trellises, shiftless, desuetude, shyness

   Key: shyness

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from The Goophered Grapevine, paragraph 40: “Mars Dugal' up 'n tuk Henry ter town, en sole 'im fer _____ hunder' dollars”

   Key: fifteen

10. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Why does John come to North Carolina?

    A. His wife needs a milder climate and he seeks a business

    B. To fight in a war

    C. To visit family

    D. To teach

    Key: A (His wife needs a milder climate and he seeks a business)

11. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from The Goophered Grapevine, paragraph 31: “he paid Aun' Peggy ten dollars fer to goopher de _____”

    Key: grapevimes

12. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “goophered” (The Goophered Grapevine, paragraph 17) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The bewitchment.

13. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Mars Dugal' up 'n tuk Henry ter town, en sole 'im fer fifteen hunder' dollars” (The Goophered Grapevine, paragraph 40) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Henry sold as property, his price tied to the vines.

14. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “The Goophered Grapevine”?

    A. The cost of wanting to seem richer than you are

    B. Friendship tested by duty

    C. A story told to protect a livelihood

    D. A boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion

    Key: C (A story told to protect a livelihood)

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “he paid Aun' Peggy ten dollars fer to goopher de grapevimes” (The Goophered Grapevine, paragraph 31). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Conjure as a business arrangement.

16. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “The Goophered Grapevine”? John narrates in standard English; Julius's tale is told in dialect, letting two worldviews collide.

    A. FrameNarrative

    B. Setting

    C. Hyperbole

    D. Imagery

    Key: A (FrameNarrative)

17. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “The Goophered Grapevine”? The "superstitious" story is economically shrewd.

    A. Diction / vocabulary

    B. Irony

    C. Characterization

    D. Alliteration

    Key: B (Irony)

18. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “goophered” (The Goophered Grapevine, paragraph 17) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: The bewitchment.

19. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Julius's tale is both entertainment and an act of resistance. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Mars Dugal' up 'n tuk Henry ter town, en sole 'im fer fifteen hunder' dollars” (The Goophered Grapevine, paragraph 40).

    Sample answer: The "goophered" vines protect his own income, and the detail that the master "sole 'im fer fifteen hunder' dollars" when Henry was strong exposes an economy that treated a man like a crop.

20. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how the economics of slavery develops from an earlier story to “The Goophered Grapevine”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Henry is treated as property whose value rises and falls with the vines.

21. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Mars Dugal' up 'n tuk Henry ter town, en sole 'im fer fifteen hunder' dollars” (The Goophered Grapevine, paragraph 40) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Henry sold as property, his price tied to the vines.

22. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the story: “Julius's tale is both entertainment and an act of resistance.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: The "goophered" vines protect his own income, and the detail that the master "sole 'im fer fifteen hunder' dollars" when Henry was strong exposes an economy that treated a man like a crop.

23. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Several planters thereabouts had attempted it on a commercial scale, in former years, with greater or less success; but like most Southern industries, it had felt the blight of war and had fallen into desuetude.”, what does “desuetude” most nearly mean?

    A. a state of disuse; no longer being used or kept up

    B. frames of crossed strips on which climbing plants grow

    C. lazy and lacking ambition

    D. a long speech by one person

    Key: A (a state of disuse; no longer being used or kept up)

24. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "The vines—here partly supported by decayed and broken-down trellises, there twining themselves among the branches of the slender saplings which had sprung up among them—grew in wild and unpruned luxuriance, and the few…", what does "trellises" most nearly mean?

    A. a state of disuse; no longer being used or kept up

    B. frames of crossed strips on which climbing plants grow

    C. lazy and lacking ambition

    D. a long speech by one person

    Key: B (frames of crossed strips on which climbing plants grow)

25. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "As he became more and more absorbed in the narrative, his eyes assumed a dreamy expression, and he seemed to lose sight of his auditors, and to be living over again in monologue his life on the old plantation.", what does "monologue" most nearly mean?

    A. a state of disuse; no longer being used or kept up

    B. frames of crossed strips on which climbing plants grow

    C. a long speech by one person

    D. lazy and lacking ambition

    Key: C (a long speech by one person)

26. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "The estate had been for years involved in litigation between disputing heirs, during which period shiftless cultivation had well-nigh exhausted the soil.", what does "shiftless" most nearly mean?

    A. frames of crossed strips on which climbing plants grow

    B. a long speech by one person

    C. lazy and lacking ambition

    D. a state of disuse; no longer being used or kept up

    Key: C (lazy and lacking ambition)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18	recall 11, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	3, 6, 7, 5, 8, 11, 10, 2, 9, 4, 1, 14, 12, 13, 19, 17, 15, 20	recall 11, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	8, 2, 10, 7, 9, 5, 3, 4, 6, 11, 14, 13, 12, 15, 19, 16, 20, 21	recall 10, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	3, 2, 1, 11, 8, 7, 9, 5, 6, 13, 14, 12, 16, 15, 17, 19, 20, 22	recall 9, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	9, 1, 6, 2, 7, 8, 11, 10, 13, 12, 14, 17, 16, 19, 15, 20, 21, 18	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	23, 11, 3, 8, 4, 10, 6, 13, 14, 12, 17, 15, 19, 16, 22, 20, 21, 18	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Freshman	9, 24, 1, 25, 7, 5, 4, 13, 14, 12, 19, 15, 16, 17, 20, 21, 18, 22	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4

College Sophomore	25, 3, 8, 11, 5, 4, 1, 13, 12, 14, 17, 16, 19, 15, 20, 22, 18, 21	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Junior	23, 10, 11, 4, 26, 9, 25, 14, 13, 12, 17, 16, 15, 19, 20, 22, 21, 18	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Senior	25, 7, 26, 2, 9, 5, 10, 12, 14, 13, 16, 15, 17, 19, 21, 20, 18, 22	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
Graduate / PhD	5, 24, 10, 23, 6, 26, 9, 13, 14, 12, 17, 15, 19, 16, 18, 22, 21, 20	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4

Final paper

The Goophered Grapevine: final paper (formal literary analysis). Choose one prompt.

1. Analyze how Charles W. Chesnutt develops slavery and its memory across The Goophered Grapevine. Trace the idea through at least three moments (beginning, middle and end) and argue what the ending finally suggests.
2. Choose one recurring symbol, image or motif in The Goophered Grapevine and argue how its meaning changes over the story and why that change matters to storytelling as resistance.
3. Analyze a central character's choices in The Goophered Grapevine. Argue whether the story judges that character, and how its structure or point of view shapes your answer.
4. Two readers disagree about whether The Goophered Grapevine finally endorses or criticizes its society's view of race and economics. Weigh both readings and argue for one, answering the strongest objection.

Length: Scaffolded support 500-700 words; HS Freshman 700-900 words; HS Sophomore 900-1,100 words; HS Junior 1,000-1,300 words; HS Senior 1,200-1,500 words; AP 1,300-1,600 words; College Freshman 1,500-2,000 words; College Sophomore 2,000-2,500 words; College Junior 2,500-3,000 words; College Senior 3,000-4,000 words; Graduate / PhD 4,000-6,000 words

Evidence requirement: at least 4 quotations from at least two parts of the story. Quote the reading text exactly and cite the paragraph (MLA style). HS Senior and above: one scholarly or historical source; College Sophomore and above: two, cited in MLA.

Criterion	Points	Descriptor
Thesis	20	A specific, arguable claim that answers the prompt and organizes the paper.
Evidence	25	Well-chosen, accurately quoted and cited passages from across the work, meeting the evidence requirement.
Analysis	30	Explains how language, structure and literary elements create meaning; goes beyond summary.
Organization	15	Logical progression, clear topic sentences and transitions; introduction and conclusion frame the argument.
Style and conventions	10	Formal academic voice, present tense for literature, correct grammar and MLA format.

Essay assignments

Essay: Slavery and its memory

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Goophered Grapevine teaches about slavery and its memory. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Charles W. Chesnutt develops slavery and its memory in The Goophered Grapevine. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Charles W. Chesnutt develops slavery and its memory across The Goophered Grapevine. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Goophered Grapevine (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of slavery and its memory. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of slavery and its memory in The Goophered Grapevine. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Charles W. Chesnutt's choices in The Goophered Grapevine (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of slavery and its memory, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Goophered Grapevine's treatment of slavery and its memory in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on slavery and its memory in The Goophered Grapevine that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on slavery and its memory in The Goophered Grapevine. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about slavery and its memory in The Goophered Grapevine, engaging at least

four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on slavery and its memory in The Goophered Grapevine, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Storytelling as resistance

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Goophered Grapevine teaches about storytelling as resistance. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Charles W. Chesnutt develops storytelling as resistance in The Goophered Grapevine. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Charles W. Chesnutt develops storytelling as resistance across The Goophered Grapevine. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Goophered Grapevine (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of storytelling as resistance. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of storytelling as resistance in The Goophered Grapevine. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Charles W. Chesnutt's choices in The Goophered Grapevine (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of storytelling as resistance, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Goophered Grapevine's treatment of storytelling as resistance in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on storytelling as resistance in The Goophered Grapevine that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on storytelling as resistance in The Goophered Grapevine. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about storytelling as resistance in The Goophered Grapevine, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on storytelling as resistance in The Goophered Grapevine, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Race and economics

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Goophered Grapevine teaches about race and economics. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Charles W. Chesnutt develops race and economics in The Goophered Grapevine. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Charles W. Chesnutt develops race and economics across The Goophered Grapevine. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Goophered Grapevine (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of race and economics. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of race and economics in The Goophered Grapevine. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Charles W. Chesnutt's choices in The Goophered Grapevine (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of race and economics, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Goophered Grapevine's treatment of race and economics in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on race and economics in The Goophered Grapevine that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on race and economics in The Goophered Grapevine. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about race and economics in The Goophered Grapevine, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on race and economics in The Goophered Grapevine, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

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